

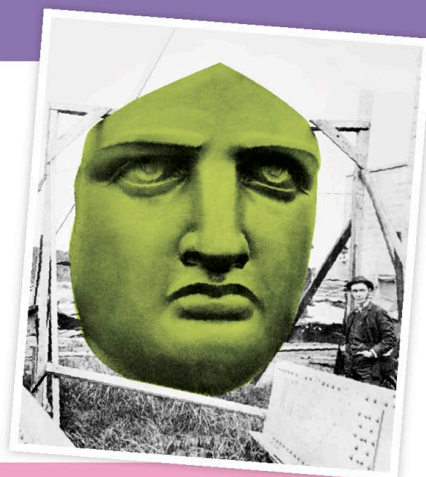
June

17

1885

Green goddess

A ship carrying the Statue of Liberty, transported as 350 individual pieces, sailed into New York Harbor, USA. This gift from France celebrated the friendship between the two nations and is an enduring symbol of democracy.



Born this day

1980 Venus Williams, Black American tennis player. One of the sport's greatest players, she has won four Olympic golds and seven Grand Slam singles titles.

1947

Global flight

The US airline Pan Am launched the world's first round-the-world flight service. The plane set off from LaGuardia airport in New York City, USA, and stopped in 17 cities before returning on 30 June.



Also on this day

1775 US troops killed many British soldiers in the Battle of Bunker Hill during the American Revolutionary War.

1843 The first violent clash over land ownership between British settlers and the Māori people broke out in the Wairau Valley, New Zealand.

1922 Portuguese pilots Gago Coutinho and Sacadura Cabral completed the first flight across the South Atlantic Ocean.

1631 Monument of love

Mumtaz Mahal, the beloved wife of Mughal emperor Shah Jahan, died in childbirth. In her memory, the heartbroken monarch ordered the construction of the Taj Mahal, a magnificent, ivory-white marble tomb in Agra, a city in present-day India.

